

HOUJIANG LIU

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CONTACT

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EDUCATION

University of Texas at Austin, School of Information, 2021–present

Ph.D. Student of Information Studies/Science

From Automation to Agency: Evaluating Computational Support for Research Ideation

Committee: Matthew Lease (advisor), Jacek Gwizdka, Ahmer Arif (Barnard College), & Aniket Kittur (CMU)

Northeastern University, College of Arts, Media and Design, June 2020

M.F.A. in Design

Enriching Gifts, Experience Design to Understand Human Relationships

Committee: Miso Kim (advisor), Kristian Kloeckl, & Meryl Alper

Jilin University, College of Physics, July 2015

B.S. in Applied Physics

RESEARCH AREAS

My research in **Human-centered Artificial Intelligence** centers on **Human-computer Interaction** and **Design Research**, with a particular focus on integrating human-centered principles into AI system design.

A major strand of my PhD research involves collaborating with key stakeholders in the online information ecosystem, such as journalists, fact-checkers, and the public, **to design responsible AI to protect information integrity** [P11, P10, P9, M2]. More recently, I have expanded my interests to AI-assisted scientific discovery, **examining how large language models (LLMs) and LLM-based agents shape different stages of research activities** [P12, E4, E3, M4].

Building on my earlier MFA research, I continue to investigate **older adults' tech literacy and health** [P8, P7, P3, P2, P1, M1] and **information visualization** [P6, P4, D1].

AWARDS

Best Paper Honorable Mention, ACM CSCW, 2024

Recognition is awarded to the top 4% of submitted papers. [[Official announcement](#)]

Information is Beautiful Awards (longlist), Data Visualization Society, 2022

The Information is Beautiful Awards (longlist) highlight exceptional global entries in data visualization, infographics, and information art, serving as showcases for finalists each year. [[Showcase](#), [Software](#), [Code](#)]

First Design Award, Health x Design Challenge, Mad*Pow, 2019

Winner of the 2019 Health Experience Design Challenge, recognizes innovative projects that promote health, financial wellbeing, and social impact, organized by Mad*Pow (now part of BORN Consulting Group) and Robert Wood Johnson Foundation. [[Press](#)]

Innovative Design Award, Reinventing Tencent Map, Tencent, 2014

Winner of the 2014 Tencent Map Redesign, recognized for pioneering the integration of Augmented Reality (AR) features into the mobile application.

RESEARCH GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIP

E. Glynn Harmon Excellence Fund, University of Texas at Austin, 2026

Outstanding Graduate Research Fellowship, University of Texas at Austin, 2025-26

Professional Development Award, University of Texas at Austin, 2023, 24, 25

Summer Research Grant, University of Texas at Austin, 2023

Deans' Award for Research Scholarship and Creativity, Northeastern University, 2020

Summer Research Grant, Northeastern University, 2019

Graduate Student Scholarship, Northeastern University, 2018–20

Undergrad Merit Scholarship (plus awarded direct admission to graduate program),

Jilin University, 2012–13, 2015

PUBLICATIONS (Authors with equal contributions are marked with *)

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings and Journal [P]

[P12] Sanjana Gautam, **Houjiang Liu**, Yujin Choi, and Matthew Lease. How Researchers Navigate Accountability, Transparency, and Trust When Using AI Tools in Early-Stage Research: A Think-Aloud Study. In: *Proceedings of the 9th ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency*, pp. 1494–1512, 2026, Montréal, Canada, 2026. [[DOI](#), [arXiv](#)]

[P11] **Houjiang Liu**, Jacek Gwizdka, and Matthew Lease. Exploring Multidimensional Checkworthiness: Designing AI-assisted Claim Prioritization for Human Fact-checkers. *Proceedings of ACM Human-Computer Interaction*, 9 (7): CSCW292, 49 pages, 2025. [[DOI](#), [arXiv](#), [Code](#), [Slides](#), [Video](#)]

[P10] **Houjiang Liu***, Anubrata Das*, Alexander Boltz*, Didi Zhou, Daisy Pinaroc, Matthew Lease, and Min Kyung Lee. Human-centered NLP Fact-checking: Co-Designing with Fact-checkers using Matchmaking for AI. *Proceedings of ACM Human-Computer Interaction*. 8, CSCW2, Article 423, 44 pages, 2024. [[DOI](#), [arXiv](#), [Slides](#)] **Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 4%)**

[P9] Anubrata Das, **Houjiang Liu**, Venelin Kovatchev, and Matthew Lease. The state of human-centered NLP technology for fact-checking. *Information Processing & Management*, 60(2) :103219, 2023. [[DOI](#), [arXiv](#)]

[P8] **Houjiang Liu***, Estefania Ciliotta Chehade*, William Albert, and Miso Kim. An Empirical Study of How Service Designers Use Metrics. *She Ji: The Journal of Design, Economics, and Innovation*, 9(3) :402–427, 2023. [[DOI](#), [Blog](#)]

- [P7] Mingzhu Li, Miso Kim, Liqing Huang, and **Houjiang Liu**. Designing for people you can't meet: Persuasive design to nurture seniors' participation in community services during the COVID-19 pandemic. *The Design Journal*, 26(6) :934–955, 2023. [\[DOI\]](#)
- [P6] Sara Colombo, Estefania Ciliotta Chehade, Lucia Marengo, **Houjiang Liu**, Piero Molino, and Paolo Ciuccarelli. Design for Emergency: How Digital Technologies Enabled an Open Design Platform to Respond to COVID-19. *Interacting with Computers*, 35(5) :650–665, 2023. [\[DOI\]](#), [Website](#), [Blog](#), [Video](#)
- [P5] **Houjiang Liu** and Miso Kim. Is gift a token of gratitude or an imposition of identity? Facilitating positive consequences of gift-giving with receiver-centred design. In: *Proceedings of the 10th International Association of Societies of Design Research (IASDR)*, Milan, Italy, 2023. [\[DOI\]](#), [Slides](#)
- [P4] Jiabao Li, **Houjiang Liu**, Jilie Zeng, Di Wu, Ying Ding, and Alec McGail. Shifting Winds: Gendered Structures of Academic Mentorship. In: *Proceedings of 2022 IEEE VIS Arts Program (VISAP)*, pp. 14–29, ieeexplore, Oklahoma City, USA, 2022. [\[DOI\]](#), [Website](#), [Code](#)
- [P3] **Houjiang Liu**, Ray Lc, Miso Kim, Concettina Cormio, and Meixin Yu. Designing for Distance Nursing: Reconnecting Nursing Students with Senior Home Residents During COVID-19. In: *Proceedings of the 9th International Association of Societies of Design Research (IASDR)*, Hong Kong, 2022. [\[DOI\]](#), [Slides](#)
- [P2] **Houjiang Liu**, Miso Kim, Mingzhu Li, and Shruthi Lakshmi Narayan. Technology, Autonomy, and Participation: Designing Community Games and Services to Enhance Older Adults' Technology Literacy. In: *Proceedings of the 9th International Association of Societies of Design Research (IASDR)*, Hong Kong, 2022. [\[DOI\]](#), [Slides](#)
- [P1] **Houjiang Liu**, Miso Kim, Canqun He, and Tia Thomson. Autonomy as a Design Principle: Service Design for the Technology Literacy of Older Adults. In: *Proceedings of the Cumulus Conference on Design Culture(s)*, Rome, Italy, 2021. [\[DOI\]](#)

Lightly Reviewed Extended Abstracts, Short Papers, & Posters [E]

- [E4] Huimin Xu, **Houjiang Liu**, Yan Leng, and Ying Ding. Adapting to LLMs: How Insiders and Outsiders Reshape Scientific Knowledge Production. In: *International Conference on the Science of Science and Innovation*, Boulder, USA, 2026. [\[arXiv\]](#)
- [E3] **Houjiang Liu***, Yujin Choi*, Sanjana Gautam, Gabriel Jaffe, Soo Young Rieh, and Matthew Lease. Effects of Varying Control vs. Automation in Human-in-the-loop Research Ideation. In: *Amazon Research Day, Workshop on AI co-scientist: Accelerating Scientific Discovery through Intelligent AI Collaboration*, Palo Alto, USA, 2026. [\[pdf\]](#)
- [E2] Anubrata Das, **Houjiang Liu**, Venelin Kovatchev, and Matthew Lease. The Need for Human-centered Design in Fact-checking Research. In: *Proceedings of the 1st Information Processing & Management (IP&M) Conference*, Xiamen, China, 2022. [\[pdf\]](#)

- [E1] **Houjiang Liu**, Enriching Family Gifts: Reciprocity in Family Relationships (Extended Abstract of C5). *NA PhD by Design Symposium*, New York University, USA, 2020. (Symposium canceled due to COVID19 shutdown)

Pre-print Manuscripts [M]

- [M4] **Houjiang Liu***, Yujin Choi*, Sanjana Gautam, Gabriel Jaffe, Soo Young Rieh, and Matthew Lease. Who Owns Creativity and Who Does the Work? Trade-offs in LLM-Supported Research Ideation. 2026. [[arXiv](#)]
- [M3] **Houjiang Liu**, Yiheng Su, and Matthew Lease. Rhetorical XAI: Explaining AI's Benefits as well as its Use via Rhetorical Design. 2025. [[arXiv](#)]
- [M2] **Houjiang Liu***, Li Shi*, Yian Wong, Utkarsh Mujumdar, Dan Zhang, Jacek Gwizdka, and Matthew Lease. Reducing Confirmation Bias on Controversial Issues through LLM-Generated Multi-Persona Debates. 2024. [[arXiv](#)]
- [M1] Jiaxin An, Siqu Yi, Yao Lyu, **Houjiang Liu**, and Yan Zhang. Conversational Agents for Older Adults' Health: A Systematic Literature Review. 2025. [[arXiv](#)]

DESIGN EXHIBITION

- [D4] Yinan Dong, Oyinkan Ifidon-Ola, **Houjiang Liu**, Kee Moon Jang, Deniz Aydemir, Fábio Duarte, Carlo Ratti. Biophilia: Mapping the Emotional Pulse of Urban Nature. In: *2025 Information+ Conference*, Boston, 11/14-16. [[Exhibition](#)]
- [D3] Jiabao Li, **Houjiang Liu**, Jilie Zeng, Di Wu, Ying Ding, and Alec McGail. Shifting Winds: Gendered Structures of Academic Mentorship. In: *2022 IEEE VIS Arts Program (VISAP)*, Oklahoma City, 10/16-21. [[Exhibition](#)]
- [D2] Sara Lenzi, Paolo Ciuccarelli, **Houjiang Liu**, and Yuan Hua. Data Sonification Archive. In: *2022 Design Research Week*, Boston, 4/25-29 [[Website](#)]
- [D1] **Houjiang Liu**, Yingyin Xu, Anni Xu, How Food is Served in Early Care Center. In: *Northeastern University Visualization Consortium (NUVis) Demofest*. Boston, 2019.

INVITED RESEARCH TALKS (Referencing previous academic work)

- [M5] Assessing Creativity vs. Efficiency Tradeoffs across Control Levels of LLM-Supported Research Ideation
- *CosmicAI Biweekly Seminar*, February 2026.
- [P11] Exploring Multidimensional Checkworthiness: Designing AI-assisted Claim Prioritization for Human Fact-checkers.
- *iSchools Global Doctoral Seminar Series*, August 2025.
- [M2] Generating Multi-Persona Debates with LLMs to Explore Diverse Perspectives on Controversial Topics.
- *Kungfu.AI* guest lecture, May 2025.
 - *Good Systems Annual Symposium, Shaping the Future of Ethical AI*. University of Texas at Austin, Spring 2025.

- *iSchool AI Showcase: Community-Engaged Research on AI and Society*. University of Texas at Austin, Fall 2024.

[P8] An Exploration of Service Design Metrics.

- *Research, Innovation, Scholarship, Entrepreneurship (RISE), Virtual EXPO*. Northeastern University, 2021.

[P2,3] Participatory Design for Senior Healthcare: Service Design to Improve Seniors' Health Literacy and Autonomy.

- *Research, Innovation, Scholarship, Entrepreneurship (RISE)*. Northeastern University, 2020.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Academic

Graduate Research Assistant, AI & Human-Centered Computing Group, University of Texas at Austin. 2021–present

Conduct interdisciplinary research on human-AI interaction, creativity support tools, and design. Lead research activities across funded projects, including study design, prototyping, data analysis, publication, and project coordination.

Design Researcher, Center for Design, Northeastern University. 2020–21

Conducted design research on service design and data visualization. Applied qualitative and design methods to investigate older adult needs of technology.

Lecturer, College of Arts, Media and Design, Northeastern University. 2020–21

Developed and taught courses in interaction design and user experience. Mentored students on design research, prototyping, and human-centered design practices.

Professional

User Experience Designer, SeetaTech, Beijing. 2017–18

Led user experience design for AI-powered products, translating user insights into product strategies, interaction flows, and interface designs.

Interaction Designer, JD.com, Beijing. 2015–2017

Designed user experiences for e-commerce platforms and services across web and mobile products. Conducted user research, created interaction frameworks, and worked closely with product and engineering teams to deliver customer-centered solutions.

Interaction Design Intern (2015 Spring, JD.com; 2013 Summer, Lenovo; 2012 Summer, Midea Group)

SERVICE

Peer Reviewer (5 x Recognized for Outstanding Reviews)

- *Information Processing & Management* 2026
- *ACM SIGCHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)* 2026 (1 outstanding review)
- *ACM SIGCHI Conference on Collective Intelligence (CI)* 2025

- *ACM SIGCHI Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS) 2025*
- *ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing (CSCW) 2022–25 (3 outstanding review)*
- *ACM SIGCHI Conference on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST) 2024, 2026 (1 outstanding review)*
- *Design Research Society Conference (DRS) 2024*

Student Volunteer

- *ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing (CSCW) 2024, 2025*
- *ACM International World Wide Web Conference (WebConf) 2023*
- *ACM SIGIR Conference on Human Information Interaction Retrieval (CHIIR) 2022*
- *User Experience Professionals Association Conference (UXPA) International 2015*

Ph.D. Representative, School of Information, University of Texas at Austin

- Research Committee 2024–26
- Master Studies Committee 2021–22

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow, College of Arts, Media and Design, Northeastern University

ARTG2400 Interaction Design, Spring 2021

ARTG2401 Interaction Design Tools, Fall 2019, Spring 2020

Teaching Assistant, College of Arts, Media and Design, Northeastern University

ARTG6330 Info Design Mapping Strategies, Fall 2020

ARTG6900 Design for Dignity, Fall 2019